A SERIOUS SPORTS PAGE

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NEWS FROM A SERIOUS FOOTBALL LEAGUE

ISSUE 37

A NEW PECKING ORDER EMERGES

SUNNY DAY
CHUCK DOWNFIELD

If Week 1 was any indication, the ASFL might be in for some new faces at the top of the league this season. Out of the six managers whose teams made the playoffs last year, four were defeated in this week's games, starting their year off with a depressing 0-1 record. One manager attempting a turnaround was Lady Melanie Shayer, who hasn't had much success since the glory days of Salute Emoji. This year, Shayer has been entrusted to manage Her Majesty's Royal Army, who defeated perennial third-place team Jasmine's Fav. After the game, reporters asked her how her team found the motivation to win. "All these players want to make Her Majesty proud... and they don't want to find out what happens when they lose." Jasmine's Fav manager Alan Tribble had a different idea for what tipped the scales, saying, "All her goddamn players had goddamn chainmail on, no goddamn wonder they hit so goddamn hard." The only two playoff managers from last year to win in Week 1 were the corrupt and opportunistic Daniel Tribble and the extremely handsome and talented Coren Hucke.

TRIBBLE CATCHES INJURY BUG

ASFL Commissioner Daniel Tribble entered this year with one big question- what should his new team be named? As the other teams in the league took shape and made branding choices all around him, he delayed his decision. Then early in the proceedings of Week 1, disaster struck his unnamed team as two wide receivers left the game with injuries. Rumors swirled of a hex placed on the franchise to punish Tribble for his indecision. In a panic, and in an effort to save the win for his team in Week 1, the embattled manager quickly found a name for his team, which will henceforth be known as Daniel Tribble's Hospital Ward.

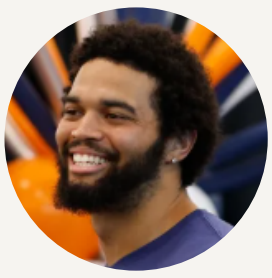


All those cigarettes are sure to send you to the Hospital Ward, kids!

Featured Matchup: A New Dawn @ Max the Manx

The two lovable losers of the league find themselves in unfamiliar territory at the start of the ASFL's third season. Through two seasons of action, Dawn Burney and Beth Tribble have had the two lowest win percentages in the league, but after this week's showings, they rank first and second. Only one will stay atop the standings after their imminent faceoff. "I'm bringing a little something for good luck," said Burney as the team's Gatorade gnome handed her a bottle of Fireball.

Noteworthies



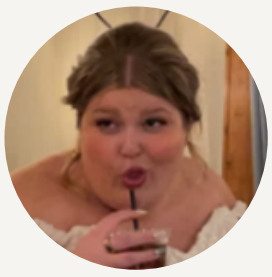
Baller of the Week: QB Caleb Williams (HW), 37.26 pts

When quarterback Caleb Williams watched two of his wide receivers go down with injuries, he knew he had to step up to lead his team to victory. When he heard manager Daniel Tribble had renamed the team, he said, "I just pictured my boys with tubes coming out of their hospital sleeves and I knew what had to be done." Williams visits Brown and Stribling every week.



Walloping of the Week: Max the Manx defeats Power Pwincesses

Beth Tribble and team Max the Manx left no doubt about who deserved to lead the standings after Week 1, destroying Mallory DeSantiago's Power Pwincesses by a huge margin. DeSantiago was shocked by the result, saying, "I peewed into the mysticaw mustache of Jawen Huwts...but it wed me astway." The Pwincesses awe pwesentwy pwepawing to pway bettew.



Nailbiter of the Week: Fellowship of the Football defeats The Girly Pops

The glitzy theatrics of Girly Pops quarterback Josh Allen were barely not enough to overcome the strength of the defense and special teams units of the Fellowship of the Football. "I'm still having trouble adjusting to the grip I get from these new acrylics," said Allen after the game. Manager Kaitlyn Hucke was optimistic, saying, "He's a real diva, he'll get the hang of it soon."



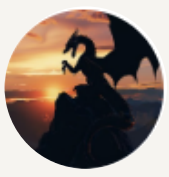
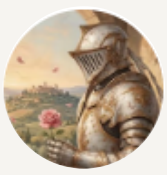
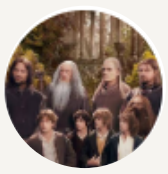
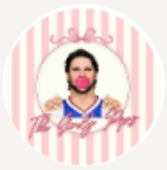
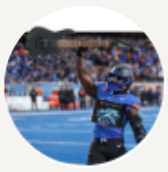
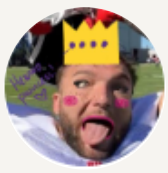
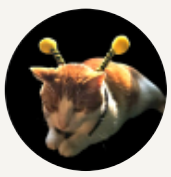
Injury News of the Week: TE Brock Bowers (FotF) on meniscus mission

Coren Hucke's Fellowship of the Football planned to meet star tight end Brock Bowers at the Inn of the Prancing Pony in Bree when they set off on their journey this season. "Oh yes, tall chap, wears a gray uniform? I've not seen him in months," was barman Barliman Butterbur's only comment. The Fellowship are hopeful Bowers will reappear soon.

Benchwarmer of the Week: WR Jalen Coker (HMRA), 33.8 pts

While the rest of Her Majesty's Royal Army fought on the field, WR Jalen Coker got a new high score on Flappy Bird, somehow scoring 33.8 points. Way to go, Jalen!

League Standings

Rank		Team	Record	Next Week
1.		Max the Manx	1-0	vs. DEB
2.		A New Dawn	1-0	@ M
3.		Lawn Darts™	1-0	vs. GPOP
4.		Her Majesty’s Royal Army	1-0	@ JENT
5.		Fellowship of the Football	1-0	vs. JF
6.		Hospital Ward	1-0	@ DUI
7.		Down Under Influencers	0-1	vs. HW
8.		The Girly Pops	0-1	@ LAWN
9.		Jasmine’s Fav	0-1	@ FotF
10.		Ashton Djenty	0-1	vs. HMRA
11.		Power Pwincesses 👸	0-1	@ BUZZ
12.		Buzzin’ Buzzers	0-1	vs. PPs